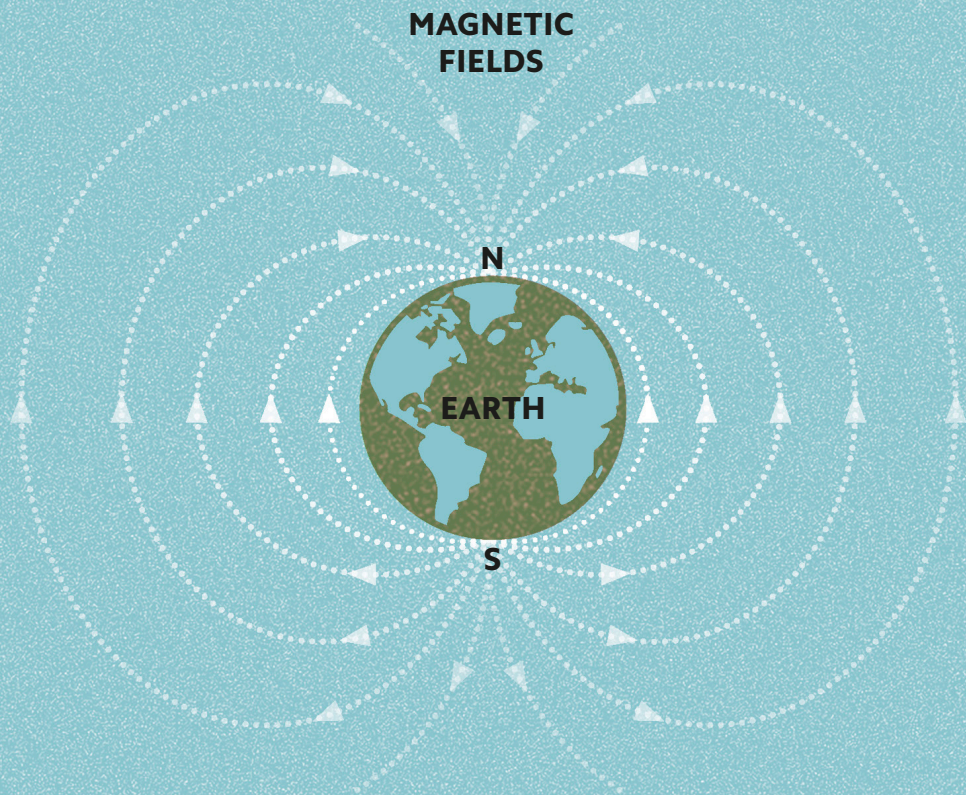




MAGNETIC PERCEPTION

Seasonal migrations see many different bird species fly vast distances between their winter and summer habitats. Experiments have demonstrated that birds rely on some sort of internal “compass” to navigate, and some scientists have proposed explanations that quantum effects are responsible. Proteins called cryptochromes found in the retina of the eye form pairs of molecules with correlated spins (see p.66) in blue light, and these spins can be oriented by magnetic fields, perhaps allowing birds to see Earth’s magnetism.